In seven years, from 2009 to 2016, only the national cricket team of Zimbabwe visited Pakistan to play one-day international matches. Pakistanis rejoiced at playing the matches thoroughly and felt thankful to them. Other countries remained too security-aware, rather apathetically, to play with the Pakistani cricket team, which had won world cups in both one-day and T-20 formats, in Pakistan. Home series were played in Dubai, UAE. Other sports also suffered because of the reluctance of foreign teams and players to visit Pakistan. Pakistan had not been able to host a Davis Cup tie since 2005, before the ITF deemed the country too dangerous, a view still shared by almost every sporting authority in the world. At this crucial time, Pakistan needed support from the international community to discourage terrorists, but unfortunately it did not happen.

Terrorist threat to Pakistan's nuclear programme

With an acceleration in terrorist activities, apprehensions about the security of Pakistan's nuclear arsenal became the centre of debates and discussions. It had been a continued and constant fear of the West that the terrorists might get hold of Pakistan's nukes. This fear became more pronounced after July 2004 when the Intelligence Bureau's successful anti-terrorist operation in Gujrat not only resulted in the capture of important Al Qaeda members like Ahmed Khalfan Ghailani, a Tanzanian national, who carried a $25 million bounty for exploding explosives in the US embassies in Kenya and Tanzania, but also the material seized from his hideout contained a 'treasure trove' of information on Al Qaeda (Musharraf, 2007). Among other materials, it included a book titled *Gas-Limo Project* that presented methods of terrorist attacks such as a plan to attack the subway stations and underground car parks in London or New York with limos filled with compressed gas cylinders that would explode. *Time* magazine had reported that this 39-page document was believed to have been written by Issa al-Hindi, an Al Qaeda operative captured in Britain in 2004 (Zagorin, 2005). This book also contained a crude plan for preparing a dirty bomb, which strongly indicated that Al Qaeda had a serious desire to prepare something similar to use against the US or later the UK.

Although the prospect of terrorist procurement of weapons has haunted the world since at least the late 1960s, when international